

You are the Caller

You call numbers, you ship patches, and the house always wins. Keep this packet face down. Nobody else reads it.

Calling

Read each number off the call sheet in order. Say it twice, clearly. Check it off.

Patching

Read each patch strip word for word, then add it face up to your stack of read patches. Never explain a patch. If someone asks what it means, read it again, slower.

Play the first five calls clean. After that, the call sheet tells you when to patch. Any time a player claims bingo, drop the next patch before you check their card.

Checking a claim

Walk to the table. Read their card out loud, slowly. Find the patch that disqualifies them. There is always one.

House moves

Use each one once, whenever you like.

- Call a number that was already called. If challenged, it was a different 14.
- Apply a patch to one table only.
- Misread a player's card out loud during a check.
- Take a mark back from a player for lag.

Ending

When the instructor gives the signal, hold up the House card and call bingo. Explain nothing.

Call sheet

Left to right, top to bottom. Pink squares mean patch after that call.

Call 1 21	Call 2 20	Call 3 7	Call 4 6	Call 5 11 Patch now
Call 6 8	Call 7 2	Call 8 13 Patch now	Call 9 22	Call 10 19
Call 11 16 Patch now	Call 12 15	Call 13 1	Call 14 25 Patch now	Call 15 17
Call 16 5	Call 17 4 Patch now	Call 18 10	Call 19 18	Call 20 23 Patch now
Call 21 24	Call 22 12	Call 23 9 Patch now	Call 24 14	Call 25 3

Patch strips

Cut these apart. Draw them in order. Read aloud unless the strip says otherwise.

Patch 1.1

Provisional Evens

Even numbers are now provisional. Circle them instead of marking them. A circled number becomes a mark only if the next odd number you mark is higher.

Patch 1.2

Blackout Lite

Lines only count if both end squares are odd.

Patch 1.3

Diagonal Lock

Diagonals only count if the center square is prime. For clarity, the primes are 1, 2, 3, 5, and 9.

Patch 1.4

Verification Tax

When your card is checked, your whole row is frozen until the next even number is called.

Patch 1.5

Cooldown

After you mark a number, skip your next mark.

Patch 1.6

Sync Penalty

If you and a neighbor mark at the same moment, both marks are void.

Patch 1.7

Pattern Swap

Only the two long diagonals count now. Marks along a diagonal must alternate circle, X, circle.

Patch 1.8

Silent Patch

Numbers ending in 7 no longer count.

Do not read this one aloud. Keep it face down in your stack. Enforce it only when someone claims bingo.

Patch 1.9

Goal Rebalance

Lines were too easy. You now win by being the first player who can no longer make any line.

Patch 2.0

Rollback

The last three patches are reverted. Except the ones that weren't.

Patch 2.1

Premium Skip

Any player may ignore Cooldown by paying the Caller a compliment. The Caller decides what counts.

House card

This card never loses.

Rage Bait Bingo					No. 00
B	I	N	G	O	
10	18	14	8	20	
17	19	21	22	1	
2	4	12	24	3	
13	6	15	7	5	
16	11	25	9	23	

Instructor key

Instructor only. Each patch breaks one of the ten basic game design tools from Chapter 2 of Sharp and Macklin, Games, Design and Play.

Patch	Tool it breaks	Listen for
1.1 Provisional Evens	Decision-making and feedback	Nobody knows if they are winning until later.
1.2 Blackout Lite	Goals	Some cards can no longer win at all.
1.3 Diagonal Lock	Constraint	The rule contradicts what they already know, and the Caller insists.
1.4 Verification Tax	Challenge	Getting close is punished.
1.5 Cooldown	Direct actions	The only verb in the game is taken away.
1.6 Sync Penalty	Context of play	Other players hurt you and nobody chose it.
1.7 Pattern Swap	Goals	The goal moved mid-play.
1.8 Silent Patch	Decision-making and feedback	A rule exists that nobody was told.
1.9 Goal Rebalance	Goals and challenge	Playing well now means losing.
2.0 Rollback	Skill, strategy, chance, and uncertainty	Not chance. They cannot tell what state the game is in.
2.1 Premium Skip	Skill, strategy, chance, and uncertainty	The skill that matters is flattering the Caller.

Debrief prompt

Each table names three problems. For each: what happened, which tool broke, and one fix. A fix that just deletes the patch doesn't count.